

أَعُوذُ بِاللَّهِ مِنَ الشَّيْطَانِ الرَّجِيمِ

بِسْمِ اللَّهِ الرَّحْمَنِ الرَّحِيمِ

Lisan ul Quran — Lecture 6

'Adad · Forming the Tathniyah from the Wahid

Hadith

الَّذِي يَقْرَأُ الْقُرْآنَ وَهُوَ مَاهِرٌ بِهِ مَعَ السَّفَرَةِ الْكِرَامِ الْبَرَةِ، وَالَّذِي يَقْرَأُ الْقُرْآنَ وَيَتَتَعْتَعُ فِيهِ وَهُوَ عَلَيْهِ شَاقٌّ لَهُ أَجْرَانِ

(Sahih Muslim: 1862 — narrated from 'A'ishah, may Allah be pleased with her)

Translation: The one skilled in the Qur'an will be with the noble and obedient scribes among the angels; and the one who reads the Qur'an haltingly, finding it hard going, will have two rewards.

Its relevance to the lesson: The last word of this hadith, أَجْرَانِ, is itself a *Tathniyah* — "two rewards". Learning to recognise that aani sound is the whole purpose of this lesson.

1. The 'Adad of the Ism

'Adad is the second aspect of the *Ism*. Urdu and English have only two categories of number, singular and plural: one for a single thing and one for more than one. Arabic, by contrast, has three categories of number, and it is this system that sets Arabic apart from both Urdu and English.

'Adad	Definition	Example
Wahid	Denotes one individual or one thing	وَلَدٌ
Tathniyah	An Ism used for two only	وَلَدَانِ
Jam'	Denotes a number greater than two	أَوْلَادٌ

2. Tathniyah and the basic rule

The process of forming a *Tathniyah* from a *Wahid* is itself called *Tathniyah*. The method in Arabic is very simple, and it is the same whether the noun is masculine, feminine or an adjective.

The basic rule: A zabar is placed on the last letter of the *Wahid* and the *Tathniyah* is then formed in one of two ways. In one form an alif and a noon, that is نِا, are added; in the other a yaa' and a noon, that is نِيا, are added. Both carry the same meaning, namely "two".

Why are there two forms?

These two forms are not accidental; they are the *I'raab of the Tathniyah*. The *I'raab* of a *Tathniyah* comes not through a *harakah* but through a letter, which is called *I'raab bil Harf*. In the state of *raf* an alif preceded by a fathah appears, and in the states of *nasb* and *jarr* a silent yaa' preceded by a fathah. In other words, the position of the noun in the sentence is what decides whether نِا or نِيا will come.

Halat ur Raf'	Halat un Nasb	Halat ul Jarr
جَاءَ رَجُلَانِ	رَأَيْتُ رَجُلَيْنِ	مَرَرْتُ بِرَجُلَيْنِ
alif + noon	yaa' + noon	yaa' + noon

3. Mudhakkar, Mu'annath, adjectives and nouns ending in a round ة

For a singular masculine noun, a zabar is given to the last letter and نِا or نِيا is added, so وَلَدٌ (one boy) gives وَلَدَانِ and وَلَدَيْنِ (two boys). The same rule applies to feminine nouns and to adjectives.

The rule for the round ة: Nouns ending in a round ة follow the same method. The only difference is that when نِا or نِيا is added, the round ة changes into a long taa'.

Wahid	Working	Halat ur Raf'	Working	Nasb and Jarr
وَلَدٌ	وَلَدٌ + اِنْ	وَلَدَانِ	وَلَدٌ + يَنْ	وَلَدَيْنِ
كُرْسِيٌّ	كُرْسِيٌّ + اِنْ	كُرْسِيَانِ	كُرْسِيٌّ + يَنْ	كُرْسِيَيْنِ
صَالِحٌ	صَالِحٌ + اِنْ	صَالِحَانِ	صَالِحٌ + يَنْ	صَالِحَيْنِ
بِنْتُ	بِنْتُ + اِنْ	بِنْتَانِ	بِنْتُ + يَنْ	بِنْتَيْنِ
إِمْرَأَةٌ	إِمْرَأَةٌ + اِنْ	إِمْرَأَتَانِ	إِمْرَأَةٌ + يَنْ	إِمْرَأَتَيْنِ
جَنَّةٌ	جَنَّةٌ + اِنْ	جَنَّتَانِ	جَنَّةٌ + يَنْ	جَنَّتَيْنِ

Wahid	Working	Halat ur Raf'	Working	Nasb and Jarr
صَالِحَةٌ	صَالِحَتٌ + اِنْ	صَالِحَتَانِ	صَالِحَتٌ + يَنْ	صَالِحَتَيْنِ

4. Forming the Tathniyah from nouns ending in an Alif Mamdudah

Besides the round ة, the *Alif Mamdudah* and the *Alif Maqsurah* sometimes serve as marks of a feminine noun. But not every one of them is necessarily such a mark, since both can also occur at the end of masculine nouns. Their mere presence therefore does not settle whether a noun is feminine; further morphological inquiry is needed.

An *Alif Mamdudah* is an additional alif followed by a hamzah. If that hamzah is additional and has come for *ta'neeth*, it is a mark of the feminine. But if the hamzah is original, that is, part of the *Huroof ul Maddah*, or if it has come as a substitute for a waw or a yaa', then it is not a mark of *ta'neeth*. On this distinction the rules for forming the *Tathniyah* also differ.

Three cases

- If the hamzah is **original**, it stays in place when the *Tathniyah* is formed and the ordinary rule applies, as رَفَاءٌ (a danner) gives رَفَاءَانِ and رَفَاءَيْنِ.
- If the hamzah has come **for ta'neeth**, it is changed into a waw, as حَمْرَاءٌ gives حَمْرَآوَانِ and حَمْرَآوَيْنِ.
- If the hamzah is **neither original nor for ta'neeth**, both ways are permissible, so كِسَاءٌ (a cloak) gives either كِسَاءَانِ or كِسَآوَانِ.

Wahid	Nature of the hamzah	Halat ur Raf'	Nasb and Jarr
رَفَاءٌ	original — stays in place	رَفَاءَانِ	رَفَاءَيْنِ
حَمْرَاءٌ	for ta'neeth — becomes a waw	حَمْرَآوَانِ	حَمْرَآوَيْنِ
كِسَاءٌ	either way is permissible	كِسَاءَانِ / كِسَآوَانِ	كِسَاءَيْنِ / كِسَآوَيْنِ

5. Forming the Tathniyah from nouns ending in an Alif Maqsurah

An *Alif Maqsurah* is an alif that comes at the end of a noun with no hamzah after it. Not every *Alif Maqsurah* is a mark of the feminine either, since it is also found at the end of masculine nouns such as عَصَا and فَيْئِ, both of which occur in the Qur'an.

Here what matters is less the gender of the noun and more the **position of the Alif Maqsurah** — whether it falls on the third letter or comes after the third letter.

First case: the Alif Maqsurah comes after the third letter

In this case the alif is changed into a yaa' when the *Tathniyah* is formed, and then نِ is added for *raf'* and يِ for *nasb* and *jarr*.

Second case: the third letter itself is the Alif Maqsurah

In this case the *Huroof ul Maddah* are consulted. If the third root letter is a waw, the *Alif Maqsurah* is changed into a waw; and if it is a yaa', the *Alif Maqsurah* is changed into a yaa'.

Wahid	What changes	Halat ur Raf'	Nasb and Jarr
كُبرَى	after the third letter — becomes a yaa'	كُبرَيَانِ	كُبرَيَيْنِ
مُصْطَفَى	after the third letter — becomes a yaa'	مُصْطَفَيَانِ	مُصْطَفَيْنِ
عَصَا	root ع ص و — becomes a waw	عَصَوَانِ	عَصَوَيْنِ
فَتَى	root ف ت ي — becomes a yaa'	فَتَيَانِ	فَتَيْنِ

6. Forming the Tathniyah from derived nouns and adjectives

For the *Ism ul Fa'il*, the *Ism ul Maf'ul*, the *Sifah Mushabbahah*, the *Alwan* and '*Uyub*, and the *Ism ut Tafdeel*, the rule is exactly the same as for ordinary nouns: a zabar on the last letter, then نِ in *raf'* and يِ in *nasb* and *jarr*.

Type	Wahid	Halat ur Raf'	Nasb and Jarr
Ism ul Fa'il	عَابِد	عَابِدَانِ	عَابِدَيْنِ
Ism ul Maf'ul	مَعْبُود	مَعْبُودَانِ	مَعْبُودَيْنِ
Sifah Mushabbahah	جَمِيل	جَمِيلَانِ	جَمِيلَيْنِ
Alwan (colours)	أَحْمَر	أَحْمَرَانِ	أَحْمَرَيْنِ
'Uyub (defects)	أَبْكَم	أَبْكَمَانِ	أَبْكَمَيْنِ
Ism ut Tafdeel	أَكْبَر	أَكْبَرَانِ	أَكْبَرَيْنِ

7. Two further rules concerning the Tathniyah

7.1 Mulhaqaat of the Tathniyah

Certain Arabic nouns are not in reality a *Tathniyah*, yet they resemble one in form or in meaning and follow its *I'raab*. These are called the *Mulhaqaat of the Tathniyah*. There are four: كَلَا ، كَلْنَا ، اِثْنَانِ ، اِثْنَتَانِ .

Halat ur Raf'	Halat un Nasb	Halat ul Jarr
جَاءَ كِلَاهُمَا وَاثْنَانِ	رَأَيْتُ كِلَيْهِمَا وَاثْنَيْنِ	مَرَرْتُ بِكِلَيْهِمَا وَاثْنَيْنِ

Note: كَلَا and كَلْنَا take this *I'raab* only when they are annexed to an *Ism ud Dameer*. If they are annexed to an *Ism Dhahir* instead, their *I'raab* becomes *taqdeeri*.

7.2 The dropping of the noon in idafah

If a *Tathniyah* noun becomes *Mudaf* to another noun, the noon at its end drops away. So صَاحِبَانِ joined to رَجُلٍ gives صَاحِبَا رَجُلٍ, and وَالِدَيْنِ gives وَالِدَيَّ زَيْدٍ. This is why in the Qur'an and hadith a *Tathniyah* is sometimes seen without its noon.

8. The rule of Taghleeb

An important rule connected with the *Tathniyah* is that of *Taghleeb*. When a ruling, a name or a form includes both masculine and feminine, but by the principle of Arabic the masculine form is used for them, this is called *Taghleeb* or *Mudhakkar-e-Taghleeb* in grammar. That is, the masculine is made to prevail over the feminine.

The reason is that Arabic gives great weight to *fasahah*, *ikhtisar* and fluency. If separate masculine and feminine forms were spelt out everywhere, speech would grow long and heavy. Hence the rule of Arabic is that where masculine and feminine come together, the masculine form is generally spoken to represent the whole group or the whole pair.

The best-known example: al-Walidan

The word اَلْوَالِدَانِ is in origin a pair of وَالِد (father — masculine) and وَالِدَةٌ (mother — feminine). But by the rule of *Taghleeb* the mother is left aside and only the masculine, the father, is put into the *Tathniyah* and spoken as اَلْوَالِدَانِ or اَلْوَالِدَيْنِ, in which both mother and father are included.

Word	Grammatical gender	What it denotes
أَلْوَالِدَانِ	Mudhakkar	both the mother and the father

A few more examples of Taghleeb in the Tathniyah

- أَلْأَبَوَانِ — in origin أَب (father) and أُم (mother), but the masculine is made to prevail and this one form serves for both.
- الْقَمَرَانِ — in origin قَمَر (the moon — masculine) and شَمْس (the sun — feminine), but the moon is made to prevail and this one form serves for both.

Taghleeb in a verse already studied: In the verse from Surah al-Kahf quoted above, وَأَمَّا الْعُلَمَاءُ فَكَانَ أَبَوَاهُ مُؤْمِنَيْنِ, the word أَبَوَاهُ rests on this same rule of *Taghleeb*. The form is masculine, but what is meant is both his mother and his father.

The same rule operates in the Jam' as well

Taghleeb is not confined to the *Tathniyah*; the same principle works in the *Jam'* too. The word الْمُؤْمِنُونَ is outwardly a masculine plural, yet its scope includes both men and women. Likewise the Qur'an frequently addresses يَا أَيُّهَا الَّذِينَ آمَنُوا (O you who believe). The outward form is masculine, but the address embraces both men and women.

وَاعْبُدُوا اللَّهَ وَلَا تُشْرِكُوا بِهِ شَيْئًا وَبِالْوَالِدَيْنِ إِحْسَانًا

(Surah an-Nisa: 36) Taghleeb: الْوَالِدَيْنِ

Translation: And worship Allah and associate nothing with Him, and be good to your parents.

9. Recognising a Tathniyah

A *Tathniyah* is generally recognised by the aani sound. But not every such sound marks a *Tathniyah*, so a simple test has been laid down.

The method of recognition: First look at the word ending in the aani sound. Remove that ending, and if a *taa' ut ta'neeth* is present, remove its zabar as well. Then look at what remains: if it forms a complete, correct and meaningful *Ism*, the word is a *Tathniyah*; if not, it is not.

Apply this principle to a hadith:

كَلِمَتَانِ حَبِيبَتَانِ إِلَى الرَّحْمَنِ خَفِيفَتَانِ عَلَى اللِّسَانِ، ثَقِيلَتَانِ فِي الْمِيزَانِ

(Sahih al-Bukhari — narrated from Abu Hurayrah, may Allah be pleased with him)

Word	On removing aani	Verdict
كَلِمَتَانِ	كَلِمَةٌ	A correct and well-known Ism results, so this is a Tathniyah
حَبِيبَتَانِ	حَبِيبَةٌ	A meaningful word results, so this too is a Tathniyah
خَفِيفَتَانِ	خَفِيفَةٌ	A correct word results, so this is a Tathniyah
ثَقِيلَتَانِ	ثَقِيلَةٌ	A complete and meaningful word, so this too is a Tathniyah
اللِّسَانِ	—	No independent singular remains; this is a jarr wa majroor
الْمِيزَانِ	—	The aani belongs to the root letters; this is a singular Ism
الرَّحْمَنِ	—	No singular results; this is a blessed Name of Allah

The difference between a Tathniyah Ism and a Tathniyah Fi'l

Sometimes both share the aani sound, but they differ in meaning and structure. A *Tathniyah Ism* mentions two things or two persons, whereas a *Tathniyah Fi'l* conveys the sense of two doers.

An easy test: If a word begins with a yaa' or a taa' and ends with the aani sound, it is not an *Ism* but a *Fi'l*.

Tathniyah Ism	Tathniyah Fi'l
كَاذِبَانِ	يَكْذِبَانِ ، تَكْذِبَانِ
سَاجِدَانِ	يَسْجُدَانِ ، تَسْجُدَانِ

10. Examples from the Qur'an

قَالَ رَجُلَانِ مِنَ الَّذِينَ يَخَافُونَ أَنْعَمَ اللَّهُ عَلَيْهِمَا ادْخُلُوا عَلَيْهِمُ الْبَابَ

(Surah al-Ma'idah: 23) Tathniyah: رَجُلَانِ

Translation: Two men among those who feared Allah, upon whom Allah had bestowed favour, said: enter upon them through the gate.

وَاضْرِبْ لَهُم مَّثَلًا رَّجُلَيْنِ جَعَلْنَا لِأَحَدِهِمَا جَنَّتَيْنِ مِنْ أَعْنَابٍ

(Surah al-Kahf: 32) Tathniyah: رَجُلَيْنِ ، جَنَّتَيْنِ

Translation: And set forth for them the parable of two men: for one of them We made two gardens of grapes.

وَمِنْهُمْ مَّنْ يَمْشِي عَلَى رَجْلَيْنِ

(Surah an-Nur: 45) Tathniyah: رَجُلَيْنِ

Translation: And of them are some that walk upon two legs.

وَأَمَّا الْغُلَامُ فَكَانَ أَبَوَاهُ مُؤْمِنَيْنِ

(Surah al-Kahf: 80) Tathniyah: أَبَوَاهُ ، مُؤْمِنَيْنِ

Translation: And as for the boy, his parents were believers.

فِيهِمَا عَيْنَيْنِ تَّجْرَيْنِ

(Surah ar-Rahman: 50) Tathniyah: عَيْنَيْنِ

Translation: In both of them are two flowing springs.

Worth noting: This one verse contains both together. عَيْنَيْنِ is a *Tathniyah Ism*, while تَّجْرَيْنِ is a *Tathniyah Fi'l*, since it begins with a taa'. This is exactly the distinction set out above.

فِيهِمَا عَيْنَيْنِ نَضَّاخَتَيْنِ

(Surah ar-Rahman: 66) Tathniyah: عَيْنَيْنِ ، نَضَّاخَتَيْنِ

Translation: In both of them are two gushing springs.

أَلَمْ نَجْعَلْ لَهُ عَيْنَيْنِ ۖ وَلِسَانًا وَشَفَتَيْنِ

(Surah al-Balad: 8-9) Tathniyah: عَيْنَيْنِ ، شَفَتَيْنِ

Translation: Have We not made for him two eyes, and a tongue and two lips?

رَبَّنَا وَاجْعَلْنَا مُسْلِمَيْنِ لَكَ وَمِنْ ذُرِّيَّتِنَا أُمَّةً مُّسْلِمَةً لَّكَ

(Surah al-Baqarah: 128) Tathniyah: مُسْلِمَيْنِ

Translation: Our Lord, make us both submissive to You, and from our descendants a community submissive to You.

Summary

1. Urdu and English have two categories of number, whereas Arabic has three: Wahid, Tathniyah and Jam'.
2. Arabic has a dedicated form for two, and the Jam' is used for more than two.
3. The process of forming a Tathniyah from a Wahid is itself called Tathniyah.
4. The basic rule: place a zabar on the last letter of the Wahid and add **عَيْن** or **عَيْن**.
5. These two forms are the I'raab of the Tathniyah: **عَيْن** in the state of raf' and **عَيْن** in nasb and jarr. This I'raab comes through a letter, not a harakah.
6. The rule is the same for masculine nouns, feminine nouns and adjectives alike.
7. In nouns ending in a round **ة**, the round **ة** turns into a long taa' when the Tathniyah is formed, as **جَنَّة** gives **جَنَّتَانِ**.
8. In an Alif Mamdudah, an original hamzah stays in place, a hamzah of ta'neeth becomes a waw, and one that is neither allows both ways.
9. An Alif Maqsurah coming after the third letter becomes a yaa'; if it is itself the third letter, it becomes a waw or a yaa' according to the Huroof ul Maddah.
10. The Ism ul Fa'il, Ism ul Ma'ul, Sifah Mushabbahah, Alwan, 'Uyub and Ism ut Tafdeel all form the Tathniyah by the ordinary rule.
11. **إِثْنَانِ** and **كِلَا**, **كِلْتَا**, **إِثْنَانِ** are the Mulhaqaat of the Tathniyah: not a Tathniyah in themselves, yet carrying its I'raab.
12. When a Tathniyah becomes Mudaf to a noun, its noon drops away, as in **صَاحِبَا رَجُلٍ**.
13. The rule of Taghleeb is that where masculine and feminine come together, the masculine form is made to prevail and used for both.
14. **أَلْوَالِدَانِ** is in origin a pair of **وَالِد** and **وَالِدَة**, but by Taghleeb only the masculine is put into the Tathniyah and used for both.
15. The grammatical gender of **أَلْوَالِدَانِ** is masculine, while in what it denotes both mother and father are included.
16. Taghleeb operates in the Jam' as well, as in **يَا أَيُّهَا الَّذِينَ آمَنُوا** and **الْمُؤْمِنُونَ**, which include both men and women.
17. A Tathniyah is recognised by removing the aani ending and seeing whether a correct and meaningful singular remains.
18. **الرَّحْمَنُ** and **الْمَيِّزَانِ** carry the aani sound but are not a Tathniyah.
19. If a word begins with a yaa' or a taa' and ends with the aani sound, it is a Tathniyah Fi'l, not a Tathniyah Ism.

Exercise

1. Explain the difference between the systems of number in Arabic and in Urdu.
2. Define Tathniyah and write the basic rule for forming it.

3. When does تَانِ come and when تَيْنِ? Give one example for each of the three states.
4. Form the Tathniyah of the following: وَلَدٌ , بِنْتُ , صَالِحٌ , كُرْسِيٌّ.
5. What change occurs when the Tathniyah of a noun ending in a round ة is formed? Give three examples.
6. رَفَاءٌ , حَمْرَاءٌ and كِسَاءٌ all end in an Alif Mamdudah, so why do their Tathniyah rules differ?
7. The third letter of both عَصَا and فَتَى is an Alif Maqsurah, so why does one give عَصَوَانِ and the other فَتَيَانِ?
8. Form the Tathniyah of the following derived nouns: عَابِدٌ , مَعْبُودٌ , جَمِيلٌ , أَكْبَرٌ.
9. Which are the Mulhaqaat of the Tathniyah? Write all three of their states.
10. Define the rule of Taghleeb and explain why Arabic adopted it.
11. What is the grammatical gender of أَلْوَالِدَانِ , and who is included in what it denotes?
12. Write two examples of Taghleeb from the Tathniyah and two from the Jam'.
13. Write the method for recognising a Tathniyah and apply it to أَلْمِيزَانِ.
14. How is a Tathniyah Ism told apart from a Tathniyah Fi'l? Give two examples of each.
15. In the verse فِيهِمَا عَيْنٌ تَجْرِيْنِ , mark the Tathniyah Ism and the Tathniyah Fi'l separately.

سُبْحَانَكَ اللَّهُمَّ وَبِحَمْدِكَ، أَشْهَدُ أَنْ لَا إِلَهَ إِلَّا أَنْتَ، أَسْتَغْفِرُكَ وَأَتُوبُ إِلَيْكَ

اللَّهُمَّ صَلِّ عَلَى مُحَمَّدٍ وَعَلَى آلِ مُحَمَّدٍ كَمَا صَلَّيْتَ عَلَى إِبْرَاهِيمَ وَعَلَى آلِ إِبْرَاهِيمَ إِنَّكَ حَمِيدٌ مَجِيدٌ

اللَّهُمَّ بَارِكْ عَلَى مُحَمَّدٍ وَعَلَى آلِ مُحَمَّدٍ كَمَا بَارَكْتَ عَلَى إِبْرَاهِيمَ وَعَلَى آلِ إِبْرَاهِيمَ إِنَّكَ حَمِيدٌ مَجِيدٌ